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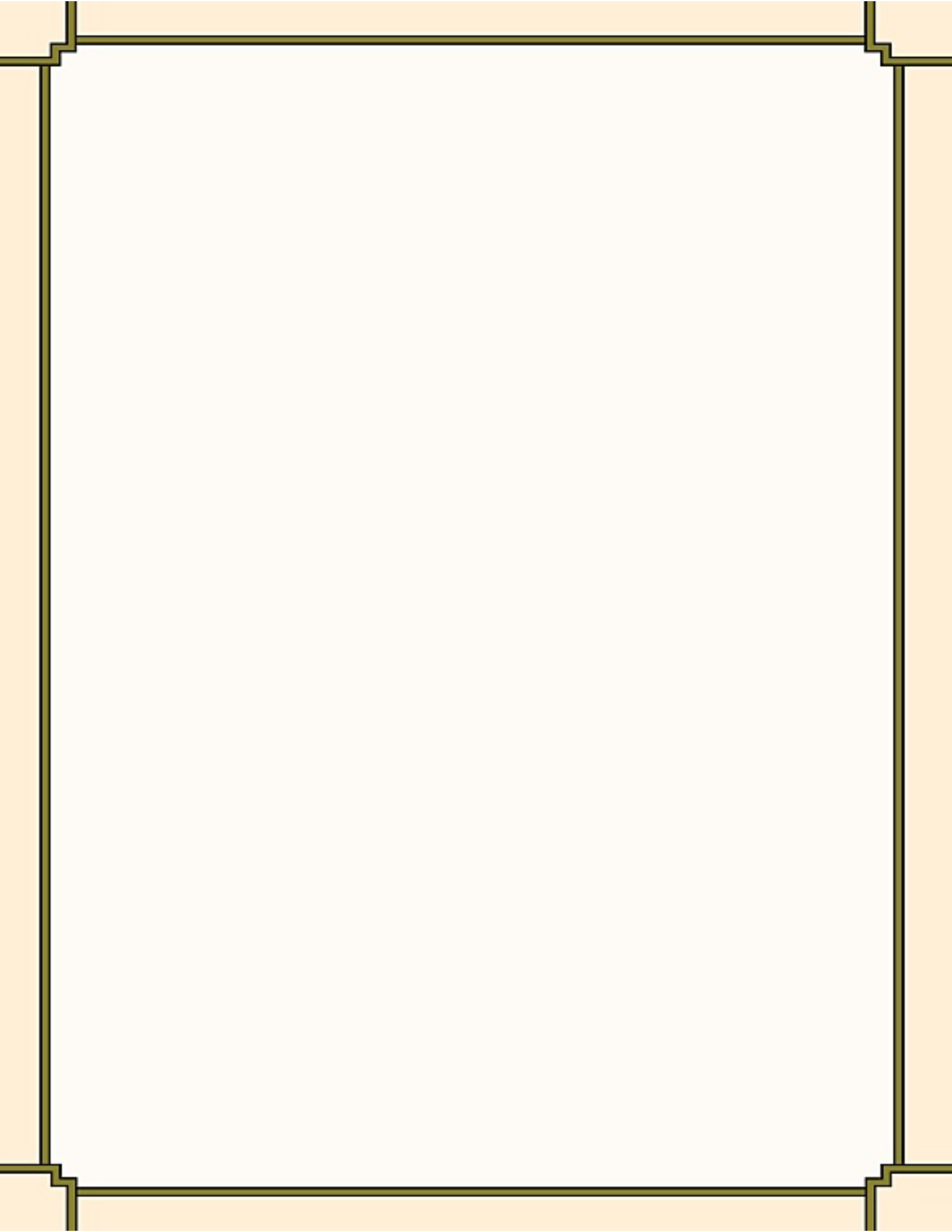
降世神通

AVATAR

THE LAST AIRBENDER™



SMOKE AND SHADOW • PART TWO



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Created by

Bryan Konietzko

Michael Dante DiMartino



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SMOKE AND SHADOW • PART TWO

script

GENE LUEN YANG

art and cover

GURIHIRU

lettering

MICHAEL HEISLER



DARK HORSE BOOKS

president and publisher
MIKE RICHARDSON

editor
DAVE MARSHALL

associate editor
AARON WALKER

collection designer
ETHAN KIMBERLING

digital art technician
CHRISTIANNE GOUDREAU



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I DON'T NEED TO BE ESCORTED LIKE SOME *CHILD*! I CAN SEE MY OWN WAY OUT!

FIRE LORD'S ORDERS, SIR. I DON'T MEAN ANY *DISRESPECT*.



TELL ME, CONSTABLE, DO YOU HAVE ANY KIDS?

A *BOY*, FOUR YEARS OLD.



TRULY, UKANO, I CAN'T IMAGINE WHAT YOU'RE GOING THROUGH. MY MEN AND I WILL DO EVERYTHING IN OUR POWER TO FIND YOUR SON. AS SOON AS THE FIRE LORD GIVES THE WORD--

BUT DON'T YOU UNDERSTAND?! WE CAN'T AFFORD TO *WAIT* FOR ZUKO TO FIND HIS *COURAGE* BEFORE WE *ACT*!

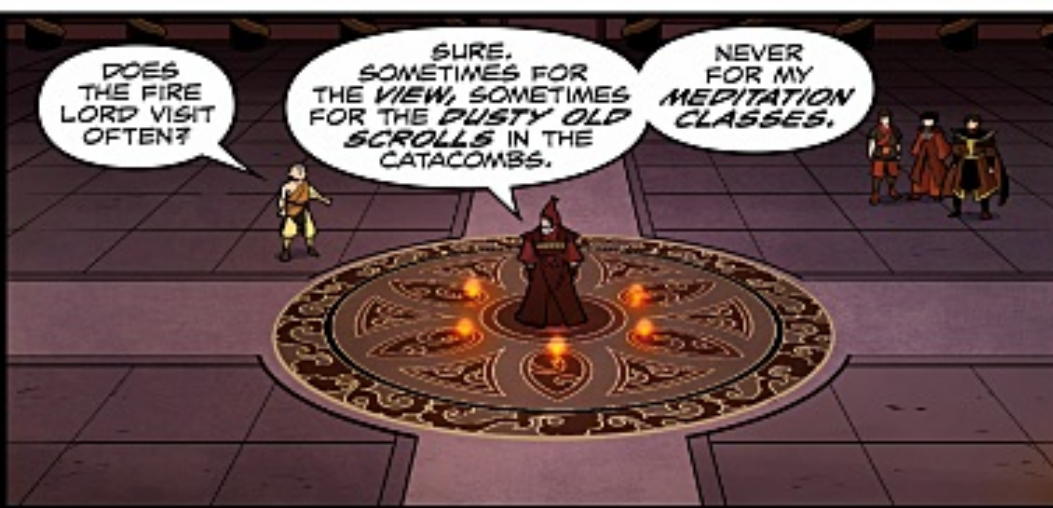


MARK MY WORDS-- THIS IS ONLY THE *BEGINNING*.

DARK SPIRITS AREN'T TO BE TAKEN LIGHTLY. AS LONG AS THAT *CONARD*'S ON THE THRONE... YOU'LL *SEE*.





















SO THIS IS WHERE THE FIRE LORDS ARE BURIED?

YES.

RESERVE A PLACE FOR YOURSELF YET?



WHAT'S THAT SUPPOSED TO MEAN?

MY GREAT-GRANDFATHER, YES.

LOOKS LIKE A CRANK.

CRANKINESS RUNS IN THE FAMILY.

IT'S JUST A QUESTION, ZUKO.

IS THIS SUPPOSED TO BE FIRE LORD SOZIN?

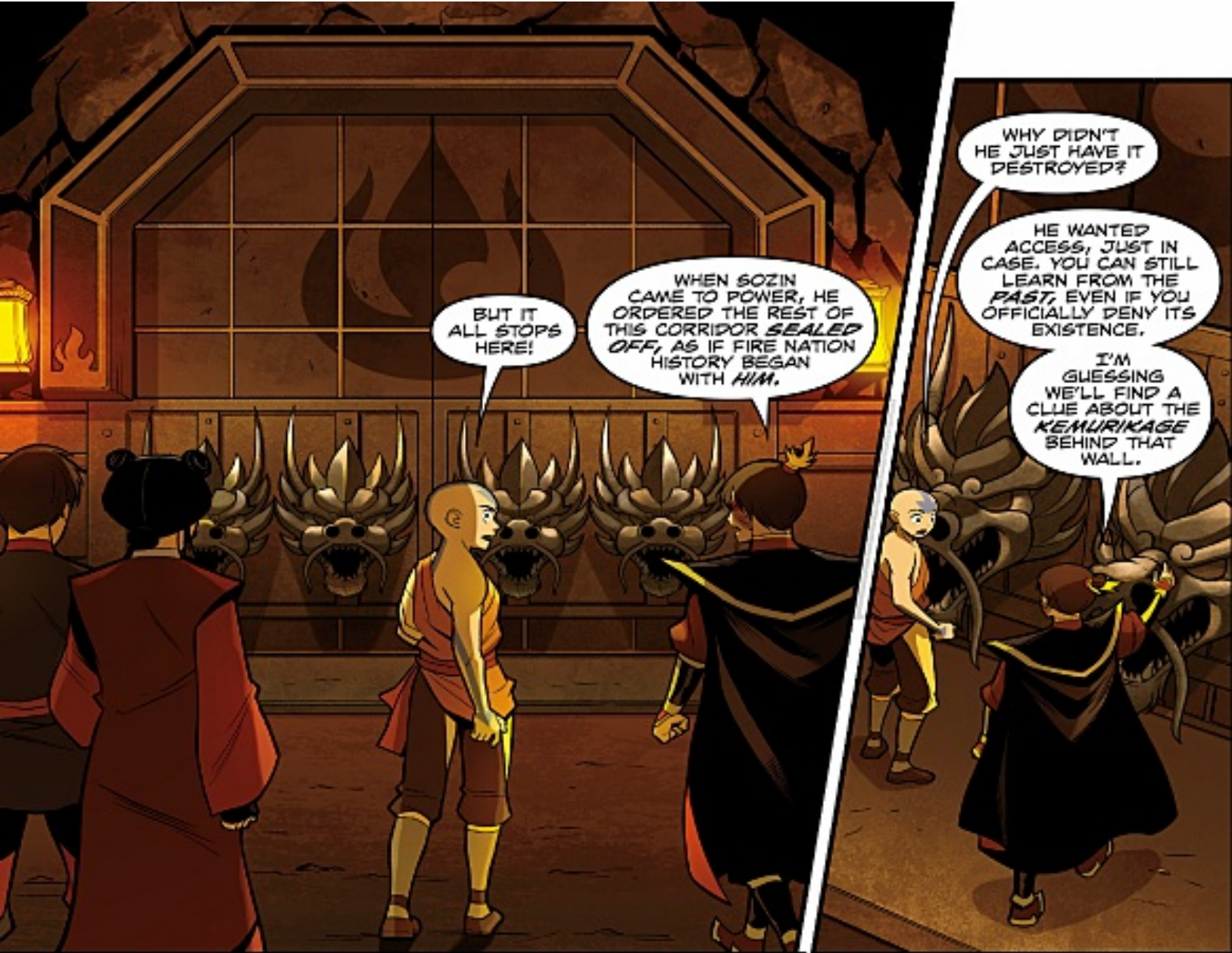


SO HOW'S THIS VISIT GONNA HELP US, ZUKO?



LOOK AT THIS. THIS MURAL ILLUSTRATES THE HISTORY OF THE FIRE NATION, INCLUDING ITS MYTHS AND LEGENDS.

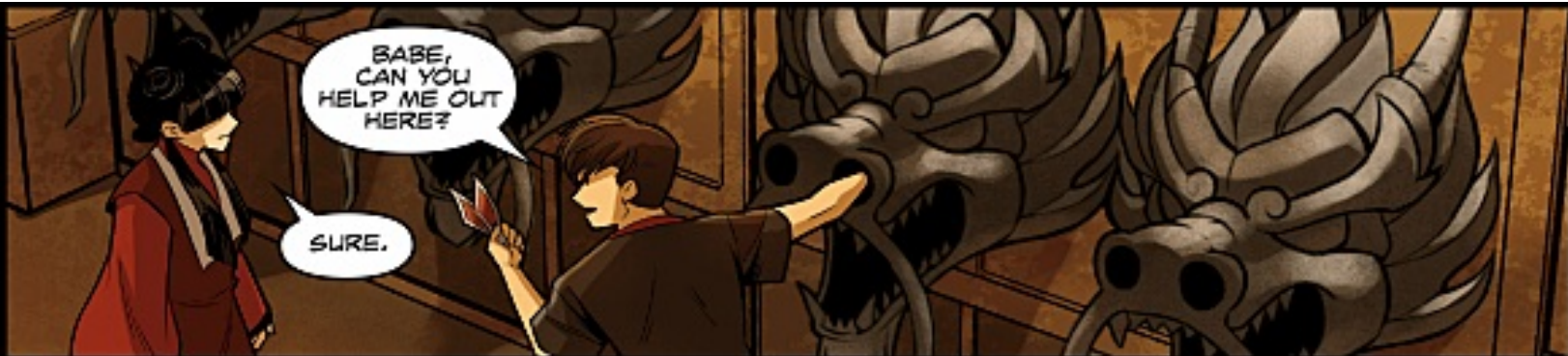
OH, YEAH!



















OH,
LOOK, MORE OF
ZUKO'S CRANKY
ANCESTORS.

HA HA!

THEY
DON'T ALL
LOOK CRANKY. THIS
GUY'S MORE...
STOIC.



HOW
MANY FIRE
LORDS WERE
THERE?

I'M NOT
SURE. THE *HISTORY
BOOKS* I STUDIED
AS A KID ALL BEGAN
WITH SOZIN.



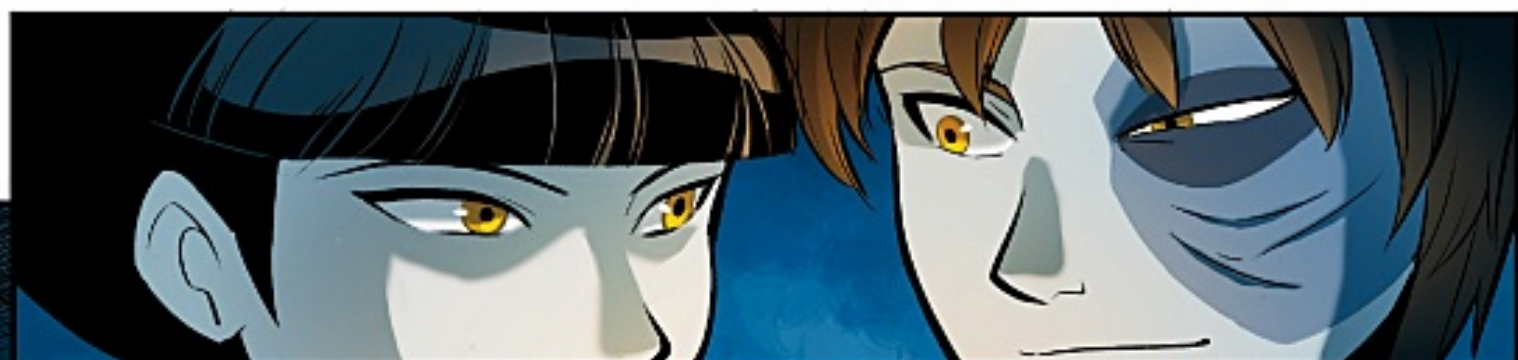
BUT
I BET THIS IS
THE *FIRST ONE*,
THE ONE WHO
UNITED THE *FIRE
ISLANDS*.

GUYS,
I THINK
I FOUND
WHAT WE'RE
LOOKING
FOR.



THE SPIRITS
WHO KIDNAPPED
TOM-TOM -- *THAT'S*
EXACTLY WHAT THEY
LOOKED LIKE!

THE
KEMURIKAGE.



"THEY FOUGHT ONE ANOTHER
FOR TERRITORY, AND OFTEN
THE COMMON PEOPLE WERE
CAUGHT IN THE MIDDLE.



"ALL THE WARLORDS WERE
CRUEL AND RUTHLESS,
BUT *WORST* OF THEM WAS
A BRUTE NAMED *TOZ*.



"FEAST OR FAMINE,
TOZ DEMANDED
ANNUAL TRIBUTES
FROM ALL THE
VILLAGES IN HIS
TERRITORY.



"ONE YEAR, A VILLAGE DARED TO REFUSE TOZ HIS TRIBUTE."



"AND SO, TO TEACH THEM A LESSON, TOZ HAD ALL THE VILLAGE'S CHILDREN KIDNAPPED."



THE CHILDREN WERE NEVER SEEN AGAIN, AND THE VILLAGE'S MOTHERS DIED IN SADNESS.



HOW HORRIBLE! WHERE WAS MY PAST LIFE IN ALL THIS?!

MAYBE THIS WAS BEFORE THE FIRST AVATAR.

SHHH. I'M NOT DONE.

*SOON AFTER THE MOTHERS' DEATHS, DARK SPIRITS BEGAN TO HAUNT TOZ AND HIS MEN.

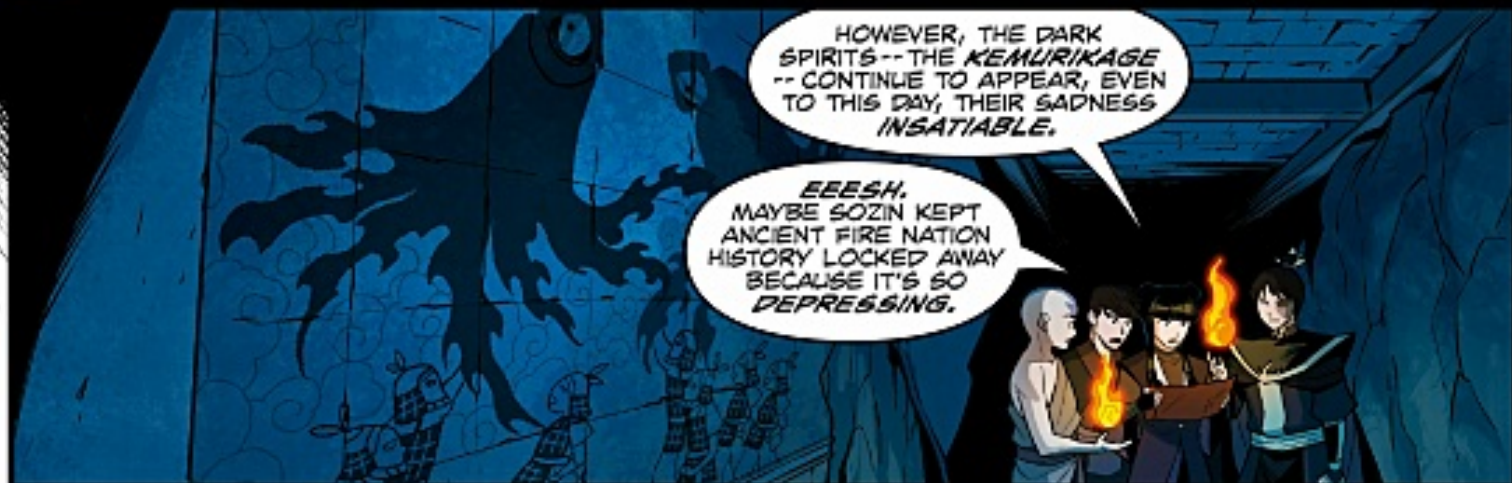


"EVERY SO OFTEN, THEY WOULD DRIFT INTO THE WARLORD'S ENCAMPMENT IN THE MIDDLE OF THE NIGHT.



"THE NEXT MORNING, A CHILD WOULD BE GONE.











A STRONG
NATION IS A SAFE
NATION!

A STRONG
NATION IS A SAFE
NATION!

AND WHO'S
THAT BUNCH
RUFFIANS?



THE
SAFE NATION
SOCIETY, A
VOLUNTEER
MILITIA.

MY
POLICE FORCE
ISN'T BIG ENOUGH TO
HANDLE EVERYTHING
THAT NEEDS TO BE
DONE, SO THEY'RE
PITCHING IN.



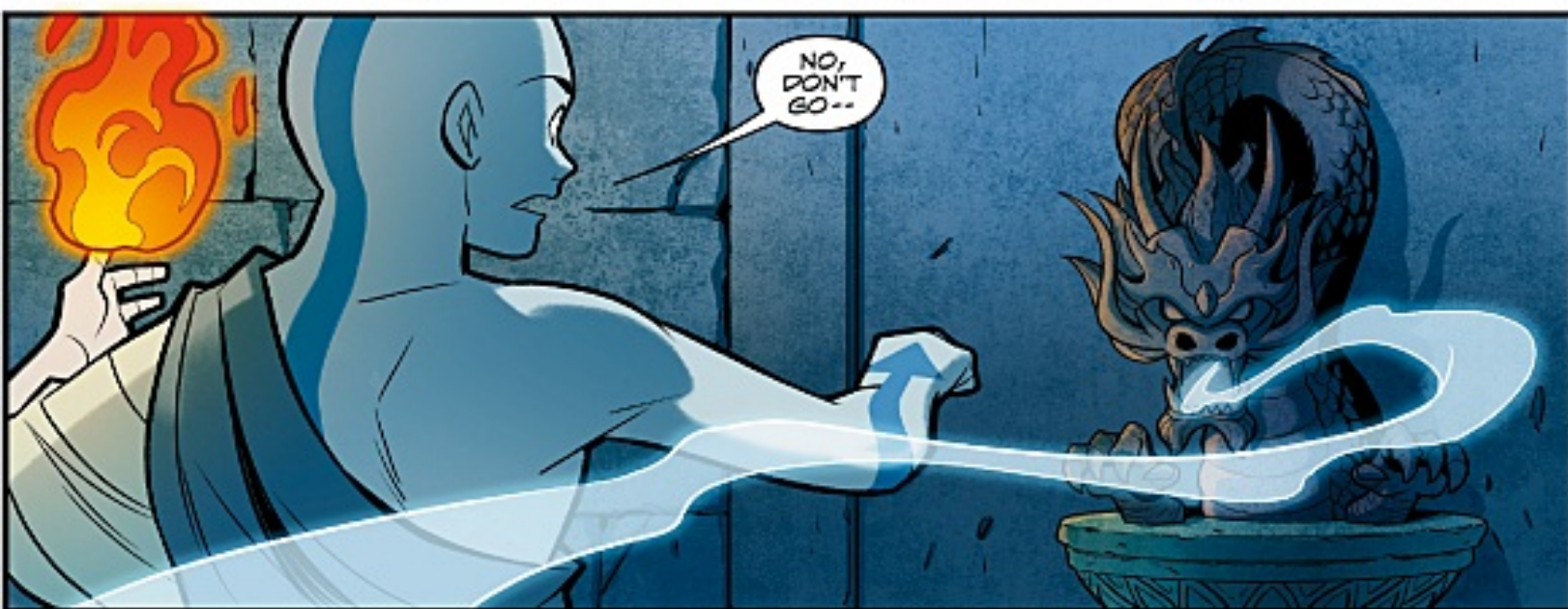
THE
CAPITAL CITY
IS UNDER SIEGE
BY **DARK SPIRITS**!
NOW GET HOME
BEFORE WE ARREST
YOU FOR YOUR
OWN GOOD!

DARK
SPIRITS...?

SOUNDS
LIKE A LOAD
OF HOOEY
T'ME!















JUST
ANSWER THE
QUESTION.

YOU BROKE
MY HEART, ZUKO!
TWICE! AND THE
STUPID THING IS, I
LET YOU!

LIKE
A COMPLETE
MORON, I
LET YOU.

KEI LO
LIKES ME. A
LOT. PROBABLY
MORE THAN I
LIKE HIM.

AND THAT'S
EXACTLY HOW
I NEED IT TO BE,
BECAUSE I WON'T
EVER LET MYSELF
GET HURT LIKE
THAT AGAIN.







WE
HAUNTED
THEM UNTIL THE
ISLANDS WERE
UNITED INTO
A *SINGLE*
NATION.

THE FIRST
FIRE LORD,
THE ONE WHO
RESTS IN THIS
CRYPT --



" -- BROUGHT THE
WARLORDS TO
JUSTICE AND
USHERED IN AN ERA
OF *PROLONGED*
PEACE."



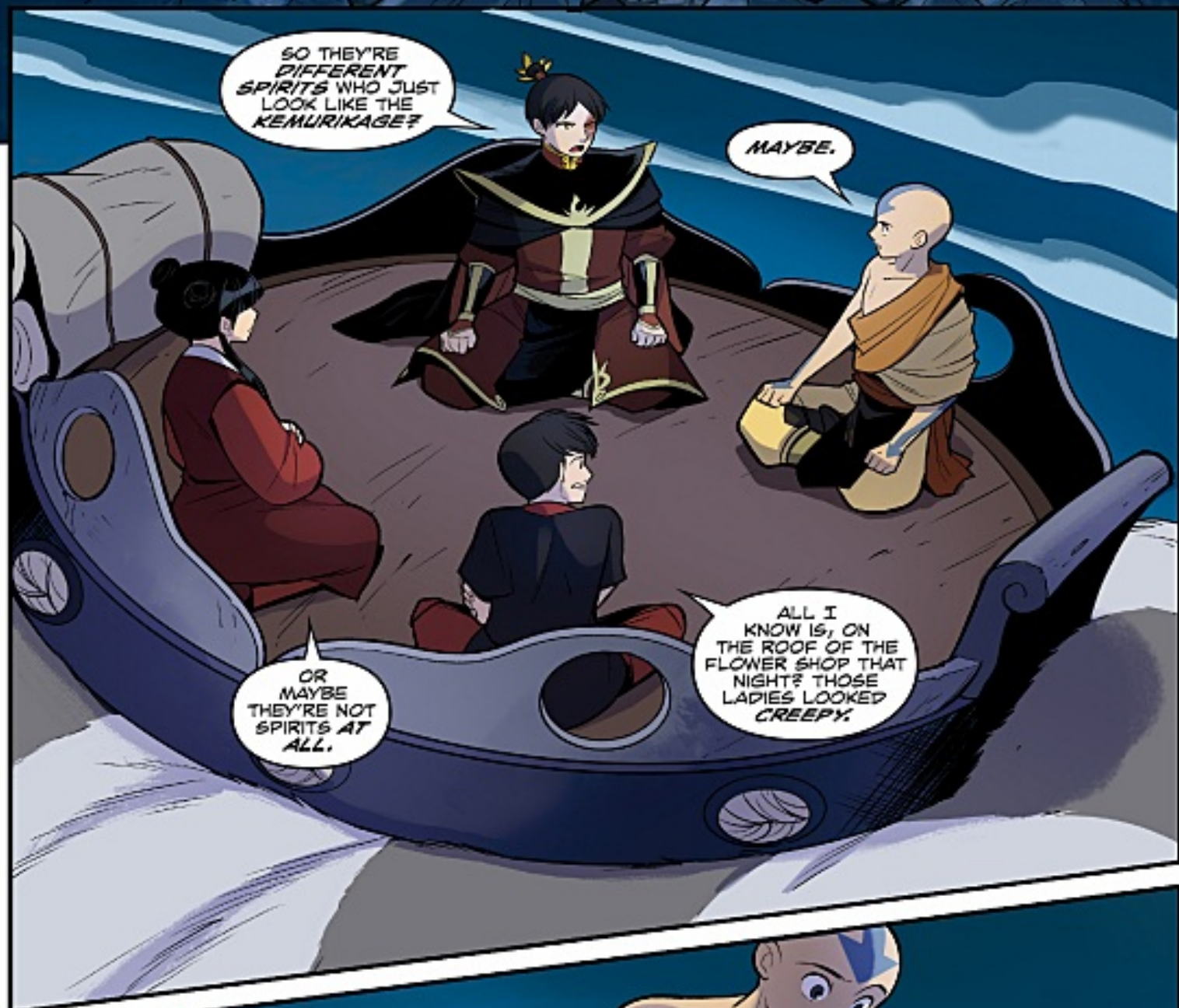
OUR SADNESS
RECEDED. WE NEVER
AGAIN SET FOOT IN THE
HUMAN WORLD.

BUT THEN,
WHY RETURN
NOW? WHY ARE
YOU HAUNTING
PEOPLE
AGAIN?



I
REPEAT,
AVATAR --

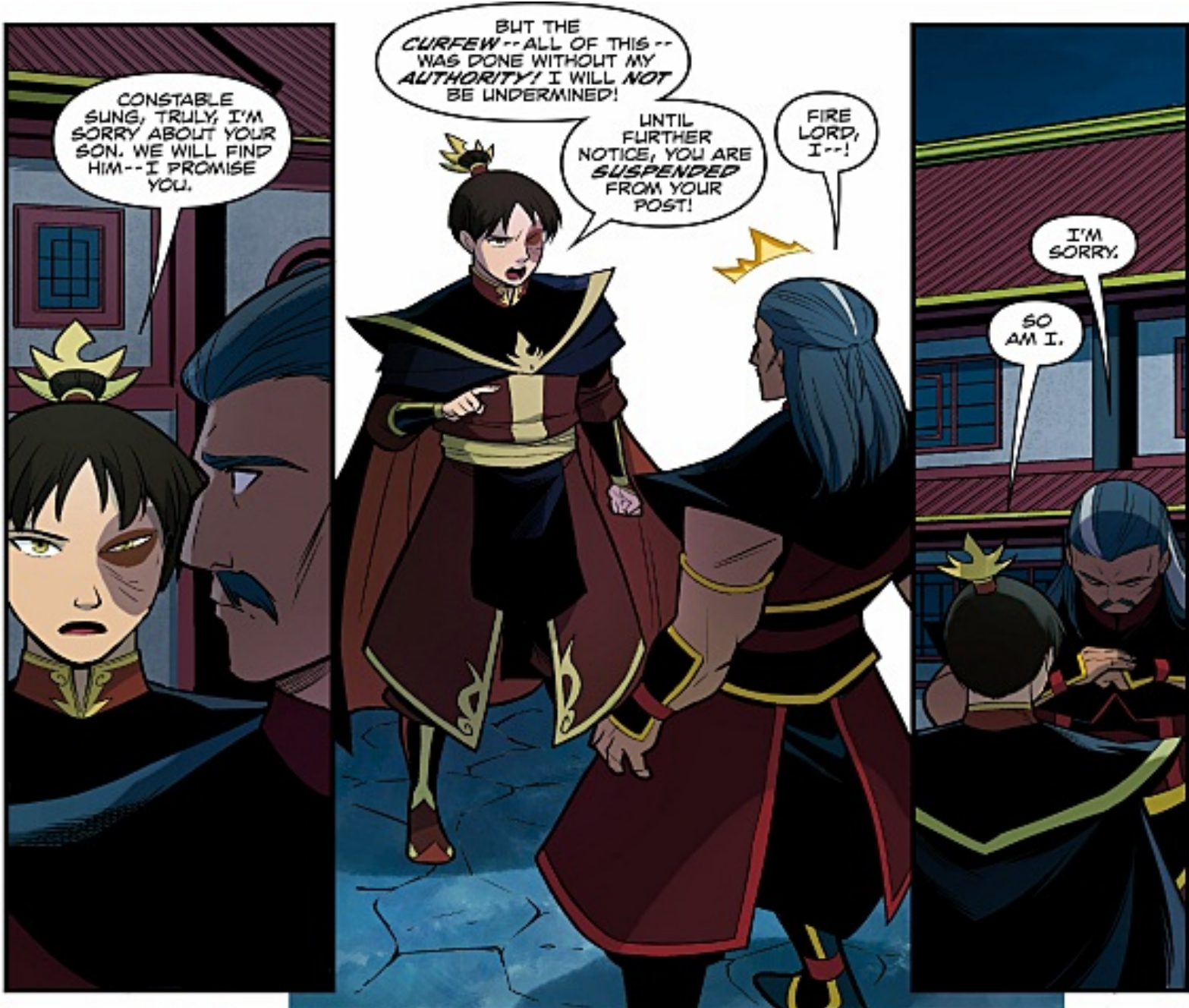
-- FROM THE
TIME OF THE FIRST
FIRE LORD UNTIL THIS
MOMENT, WE HAVE
NOT ENTERED
YOUR WORLD.

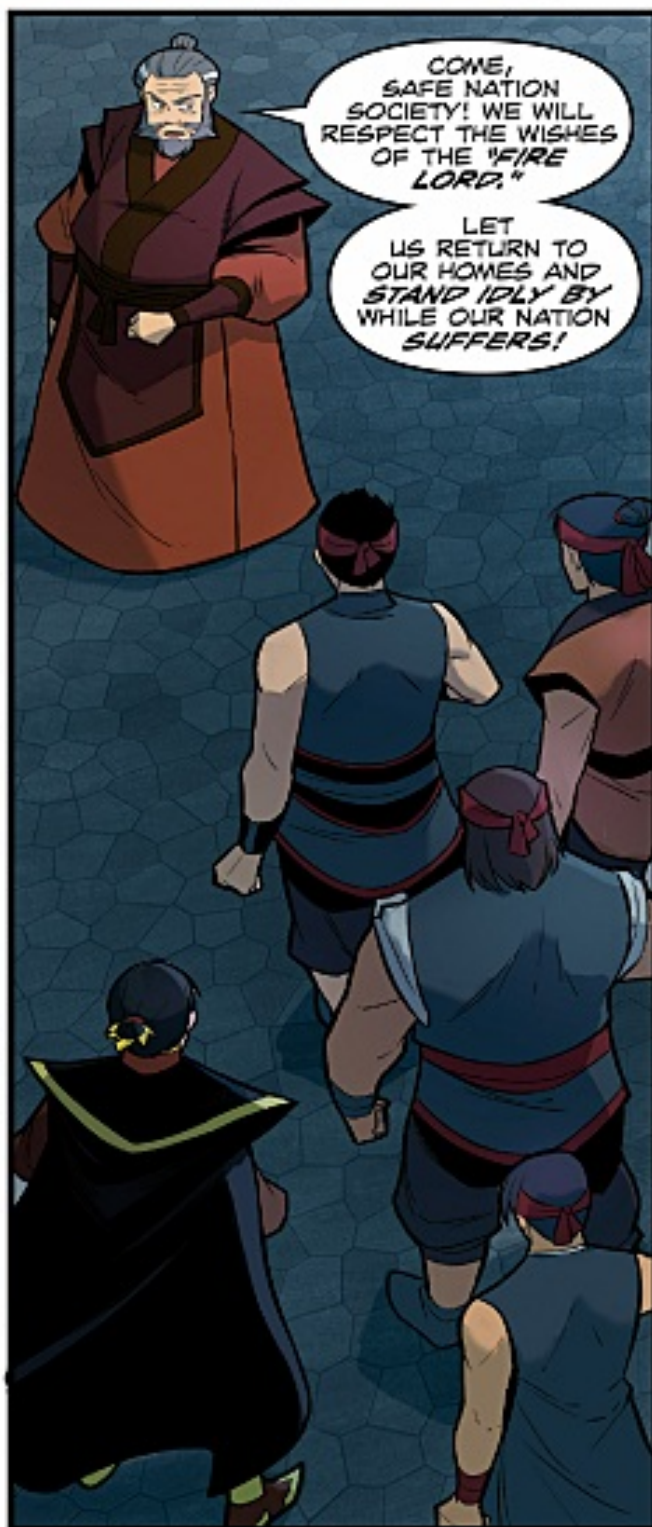
































AT FIRST, I WAS KIND OF **ANNOYED**. I WAS HOPING TO GET SOME ALONE TIME, JUST MAI AND ME, YOU KNOW?

BUT THEN, I REMEMBER WATCHING HIM RUN AFTER THIS **GLOW MOTH**.

HE WAS **SO HAPPY**. I DON'T REMEMBER EVER BEING THAT **HAPPY**.



MAI EVER TELL YOU WHAT HAPPENED TO TOM-TOM IN **OMASHU**?

YEAH.

SO YOU KNOW, FOR A LITTLE GUY, HE'S BEEN THROUGH A LOT. BUT HE COULD STILL GET SO MUCH **JOY** FROM CHASING A **FLYING BUG**.



IF WE... WHEN WE FIND HIM, WILL HE STILL BE THE **SAME KID**? WILL HE BE ABLE TO BE THAT **HAPPY** EVER AGAIN?















What is the secret of the Kemurikage?

The shadowy spirits known as the Kemurikage are abducting children throughout the Fire Nation Capital, sowing widespread fear and panic in their wake. Desperate to determine what has angered these spirits, Aang and Zuko search for clues deep in the Dragonbone Catacombs underneath the Fire Sages Capital Temple. Can they uncover the hidden history of the Kemurikage and solve the mystery in time, or will more children be taken?

Writer Gene Luen Yang and artistic duo Gurihiru, the team behind bestsellers *The Promise*, *The Search*, and *The Rift*, are back again! Developed in close collaboration with *Avatar: The Last Airbender* and *The Legend of Korra* creators Michael Dante DiMartino and Bryan Konietzko, this is the definitive continuation of the beloved TV series!



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GRAPHIC NOVEL/MEDIA TIE-IN

SON OF ULTRON

"THIS FAN...
THIS MONSTER!"

